

GCC Pharma Cold-Chain Logistics — 2026 Outlook

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Prepared by Mizan Office of Strategy + Group Research for use within Mizan Group strategic planning. Sourced from public-domain statistics, sell-side and industry research, and Mizan internal proprietary data. Not for redistribution.

Cold-chain is the fastest-growing pharma-logistics segment

The KSA pharma cold-chain logistics market is sized at SAR 8.5B in 2026, growing 21.4% YoY — more than double the pace of general logistics. Three forces drive the gap: cold-chain SKU share of the national pharma market rising from 18% (2024) to 32% (2028); SFDA mandatory GDP-WHO compliance creating regulatory moat; and biologics + GLP-1s + vaccines growing structurally faster than the rest of the portfolio.

The competitive set is bifurcated. Aramex and Mohebi dominate broad logistics; Movianto (Owens & Minor) and DHL Supply Chain Pharma are the pharma-dedicated multinationals; SAL Saudi Logistics has the cargo-handling moat. Mizan Pharma Logistics at SAR 480M is the largest fully-pharma-dedicated KSA player.

Margins are differentiated — 12-30% across the set, with cold-chain specialists at the top. Mizan at 17.4% in 2025 is mid-tier; the Dammam hub commissioning Q2-2026 lifts our 2028 EBITDA target to 21%.

MARKET 2026F

SAR 8.5B

+21.4% YoY

COLD-CHAIN SKU SHARE

18% → 32%

by 2028

GDP-WHO CERTIFIED FLEET

**Mizan
vehicles**

industry-leading

OTIF TARGET SECTOR

384

≥95%

Mizan at 96.2%

KSA pharma logistics cold chain market through 2028

Sized at **SAR 8.5B** in 2026 forecast, the market is growing at **21.4%** for the year and a projected **17.6%** in 2027 onward.

	2024A	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F
Market size (SAR B)	6	7	8.5	10	12
YoY growth %	+15.0%	+16.7%	+21.4%	+17.6%	+20.0%

Structural demand drivers

Cold-chain SKU share rising from 18% (2024) to 32% (2028) — biologics, GLP-1s, vaccines, oncology. SFDA Tatmeen track-and-trace mandates GDP-WHO compliance. Mega-hospitals + insurer telehealth pulling cold-chain demand.

Cyclical / near-term factors

- GLP-1 demand pulling cold-chain capacity tight nationally.
- Vaccine programme expansion — annual influenza + adult immunisation lifting volumes.
- NUPCO single-buyer model concentrates demand; cold-chain capability is preferential.
- EV cold-chain pilots emerging — economics not yet breakeven but capability-building.

The named players in KSA pharma logistics cold chain

#	Player	2025 Rev (SAR M)	EBITDA %	2025 Notes
1	Aramex	4,650	12.6%	Pan-regional; pharma + general express + freight.
2	Mohebi Logistics	3,200	14.0%	Private; cold-chain + FMCG.
3	SAL Saudi Logistics	2,280	29.8%	Tadawul-listed; cargo ground-handling; ex-Saudia.
4	DHL Supply Chain Pharma	1,120	13.0%	Multinational; clinical trials + biologics specialist.
5	Movianto KSA	890	15.5%	Owens & Minor; pharma-dedicated 3PL.
6	GAC Logistics KSA	680	12.0%	Pan-regional; pharma + FMCG.

Competitive dynamics — our reading

Aramex (SAR 4.65B) and Mohebi (SAR 3.2B) are general logistics players with pharma capability — broader reach, less specialised cold-chain footprint.

Movianto KSA (Owens & Minor at SAR 890M) and DHL Supply Chain Pharma (SAR 1.12B) are the multinational pharma-dedicated 3PLs — strong on biologics + clinical trials; weaker on KSA market intimacy.

SAL Saudi Logistics at SAR 2.28B and 29.8% EBITDA is the listed cargo-ground-handling leader — different competitive set, but a Dammam hub neighbour.

Mizan Pharma Logistics at SAR 480M is the largest fully-pharma-dedicated KSA-headquartered operator. Dammam hub commissioning Q2-2026 closes the scale gap vs Movianto on cold-chain.

Who regulates what, and what's changing

SFDA Good Distribution Practice (GDP) certification; MoT Transport General Authority; Saudi Ports (Mawani) for bonded import cold-chain.

SFDA Good Distribution Practice (GDP-WHO) certification mandatory. Mizan certified for full cold-chain spectrum (2-8°C, -20°C, -70°C).

Tatmeen serialisation receipt-blocking applies at distributor level; cold-chain operators must support stream integrity through scanning.

Saudi Ports Authority (Mawani) bonded warehouse licensing tightened; Mizan Dammam hub compliant Q2-2026.

Programme exposure and demand pull

Drug Security Strategy · Saudi Logistics Hub · Cold-Chain Compliance Initiative.

Drug Security Strategy — strategic stockpile with cold-chain elements.

Saudi Logistics Hub — broader logistics positioning extending to pharma.

PIF Lifera + biosimilar capacity expansion — direct cold-chain demand creation.

What could break the outlook

Anchor NUPCO contract concentration

Mizan 14% of revenue tied to NUPCO. RFP renewal H2-2026 is the single material commercial event. Defence: Dammam hub commissioning + pricing discipline.

Multinational entry pressure

DHL Supply Chain Pharma and Movianto expanding KSA capacity. Pressure on contract-pharma-3PL pricing in 2027.

EV cold-chain economics

Unit economics still 8-12% worse than diesel at current fuel + battery prices. Subsidy programmes under MoEnergy review.

07 · MIZAN IMPLICATIONS

What this means for our portfolio

Dammam cold-chain hub (18,000 m²) commissioning Q2-2026 is the capability that earns Mizan the right to NUPCO + giga-hospital tenders.

Tamween captive integration adds ~SAR 280M of internal revenue from Q3-2026; defuses anchor-customer concentration.

GLP-1 + biologics capacity expansion is the highest-margin growth vector.

EV cold-chain pilot is right strategic optionality but should not scale until unit-economics break even (no earlier than Q4-2027).